

NYC-Style Bagels

Straight dough · short ~3h bulk → shape → emphasized pan proof → cold hold · boiled & baked

YIELD	FLOUR	HYDRATION	METHOD	TOTAL DOUGH
24 @ 150g	Sir Lancelot 14.2%	60%	Straight + bulk	~3,630g

STRAIGHT DOUGH

No poolish — mix it all at once

Sir Lancelot	2,200 g	Honey (~2.5%)	55 g
Water (60% — cold if warm kitchen)	1,320 g	ADY (0.5%)	11 g
Salt (2%)	44 g		

The flour's malted barley supplies the enzyme load. **0.5% ADY targets a ~4.5h total room ferment** (~3h bulk + ~1.5h pan proof), **dropped from 0.6%** because the bench rest kick-starts fermentation and the fridge only *slows* it — the dough ripens a bit in the cold, so less yeast keeps the cold-hold honest. Start here; if they still over-ferment in the fridge, go to **0.4%**. If it drags, the granite's colder than figured — nudge up or extend.

MIX

Two batches — incorporation only, then fold

Mix straight, then divide by weight for the stretch-and-fold. Each batch makes 12 bagels.

PER MIXING BATCH ×2

Flour	1,100 g
Water	660 g
Salt	22 g
Honey	27.5 g
ADY	5.5 g

Mixer = incorporation only. At 60% with 14.2% flour the hook can't reach windowpane — gluten's too strong to fully develop in the machine. Run low just until combined, no dry bits, then stop.

Develop by stretch-and-fold: after the mix, **bench rest 20–30 min** — it relaxes and hydrates the dough so the first fold actually develops it. Then **2–3 S&F sets ~30 min apart** through the first ~1.5h of bulk; the rests relax it, the folds build the network. **Windowpane is a post-fold check.**

~1,815g dough per batch → 12 bagels @ 150g.

The consistency lever: shaping from a **bulk-fermented mass** — not pre-divided pieces — is why pro bagels come out even without a scale. A short bulk organizes the gluten across the whole dough so each piece ropes uniformly. This is the structural reason for the fork.

TEMP TARGETS

this stage — mix & dough

Room (dough rests here)	70°F	Dough after mix	~68–70°F
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Execution

ROOM (BULK+PROOF)	BULK PULL	BOIL BATH	BAKE
70°F	~50% rise	212°F roll	450°F

BULK · SHAPE · PROOF · HOLD

- Short bulk, ~3 h:** mix in the morning, then **bench rest 20–30 min** before folding. Bulk on the counter **to ~50% rise**; run **2–3 S&F sets, 30 min apart**, through the first ~1.5 h. The bulk's job is to **organize the gluten**, not the main proof — pull by rise, not clock.
- Divide from the bulk** to 150g. **Gently degas as you pre-round** — press the big bubbles out (trapped gas = uneven ropes). Bench rest **10–15 min**, then rope by **flatten** → **roll up tight** → **weld the seam** on un-floured counter (the roll expels gas). Small ~1.5" hole = puffs up, not out.
- Pan proof** — **THIS is the main proof, ~1–2 h:** rise the shaped bagels on half-sheets at 70°F **to final height**. This is the rise that makes the bagel; weight it here, not in the bulk. Float-test when they look ready.
- Fridge = mostly hold.** Bagels go in **proofed**; they'll **ripen a little in the cold** (it slows, doesn't stop) — the lowered yeast keeps that in check. Cold-hold for flavor + scheduling, boil straight from cold (brief temper).

Granite note: cold counter is a heat-sink — it slows the bulk (good, keeps it partial) but unevenly. Bulk in a **bowl** for even temp if you want; the pan proof runs warmer (pan buffers the counter) which is why it finishes the rise.

BROWNING MECHANISM

Honey-only bath — golden, not mahogany

Honey deposits a sugar film → **Maillard** fuel for color and flavor. **Baking soda is out:** the alkali browned faster (pretzel chemistry) but set a **thicker, tougher skin** that pulls away from the crumb — the same delamination that sheds everything-seasoning when you cut. Without it the crust bakes **thinner and more tender, but lighter** — **golden, not the deep mahogany that needs barley malt**. Malt is the real color + flavor fix when it's on hand.

DIAGNOSTICS

Dull, soft, over-sprung	Under-boiled — skin never set. Add boil time.
Wrinkled, tough, squat, gummy ring under skin	Over-boiled — skin set too hard, strangled spring. Cut boil time.
Skin right, interior gummy	Under-baked. Add 2–3 min; leave boil alone.
Tough bite, tight crumb	Under-proofed. Extend the bulk or the shaped room-temp rise; the fridge won't proof it. Float-test before boiling.
Tough, dried heel	Bottom heat too aggressive — skip the pizza steel (it dumps too much heat). Start on the wet boards , then flip onto a stone or pan ; a gentler deck keeps the heel tender.
Tough crumb, worse when toasted	Moisture-starved — 60% is the tenderness floor .